

One aspect that Euthyphro contradict to himself

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Euthyphro gives the definition that the pious is identical to what all the gods love (the god-loved), and he also believes that the pious is loved by the gods because it is pious, making its piety the cause of the gods' love. From this, we can deduce that if the pious and the god-loved are truly the same, the god-loved must also be loved by the gods because it is god-loved. At the same time, he believes that something becomes god-loved solely because it is being loved by the gods, meaning the gods' act of loving is the cause of it being god-loved. Ultimately, this leads to an inverted causal loop where an object's status as "god-loved" causes the gods to love it, which contradicts the previous and foundational agreement that the gods' love is the cause—not the effect—of an object becoming god-loved.